

or bias

- 3.** suggest improvements to, issues with or reasons for using maps, graphs, statistical techniques and visual sources, such as photographs and diagrams.

## Fieldwork skills

*Geographical fieldwork* may be defined as the experience of understanding and applying specific geographical knowledge, understanding and skills to a particular and real out-of-classroom context. In undertaking fieldwork, learners practise a range of skills, gain new geographical insights and begin to appreciate different perspectives on the world around them. Fieldwork adds 'geographical value' to study, allowing learners to 'anchor' their studies within a real world context. Fieldwork must be undertaken:

- outside the classroom and beyond the school grounds
- on **at least two** occasions
- in contrasting locations
- in both **physical** and **human** geographical contexts.

The assessment of fieldwork will take place within Geographical Skills (03).

The value of fieldwork goes beyond the aim of collecting primary data. The understanding generated from experiencing geographical concepts, processes and issues in the real world can be illuminating for learners. The investigative process goes beyond data collection, with other key aspects including the presentation and analysis of results, drawing conclusions and critically reflecting on the process.

The following areas of fieldwork will be assessed, through both learners' own experiences of fieldwork and unfamiliar contexts:

- i. understanding of the kinds of question capable of being investigated through fieldwork and an understanding of the geographical enquiry processes appropriate to investigate these
- ii. understanding of the range of techniques and methods used in fieldwork, including observation and different kinds of measurement
- iii. processing and presenting fieldwork data in various ways including maps, graphs and diagrams
- iv. analysing and explaining data collected in the field using knowledge of relevant geographical case studies and theories
- v. drawing evidenced conclusions and summaries from fieldwork transcripts and data
- vi. reflecting critically on fieldwork data, methods used, conclusions drawn and knowledge gained.

Fieldwork skills may be assessed in relation to either physical or human geography contexts or for both in any set of assessments.

### Fieldwork Written Statement

Centres must provide a written statement to OCR detailing at least two occasions where learners have been given the opportunity to carry out fieldwork. These opportunities must include the exploration of both physical and human processes and the two opportunities should be for two contrasting environments.

Centres must provide fieldwork opportunities for their learners. This does not go so far as to oblige centres to ensure that all of their learners take part in the fieldwork. There is always a risk that an individual learner may miss the arranged fieldwork, for example because of illness. It could be costly for the school to run additional fieldwork opportunities for the learner. However, the opportunity to take part in fieldwork must be given to all learners. Learners who do not take up the opportunity may be disadvantaged, as there will be questions on fieldwork in the GCSE Geography A (Geographical Themes) assessment.

The fieldwork statement must be submitted electronically to OCR using the form provided on our website at [www.ocr.org.uk/administration/forms/](http://www.ocr.org.uk/administration/forms/). Alternatively, the form can be accessed via Teach Cambridge. On this form, provide the following information in respect of each of the fieldwork opportunities:

- the date on which it was provided
- the location at which it was provided
- the environment to which it related
- numbers of learners who participated
- the main issues/questions investigated during the fieldwork opportunities
- the relationship of the fieldwork opportunities to the specification content.

Centres must provide the fieldwork statement by **15 May in the year the learner certificates**. Any failure by a centre to provide a fieldwork statement to OCR in a timely manner will be treated as malpractice and/or maladministration (under General Condition A8 (*Malpractice and maladministration*)).

## 2d. Prior knowledge, learning and progression

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Learners in England who are beginning a GCSE (9–1) course are likely to have followed a Key Stage 3 programme of study. No prior knowledge of this subject is required.

There are no prior qualifications required in order for learners to enter for a GCSE (9–1) in Geography A (Geographical Themes), nor is any prior knowledge or understanding required for entry onto this course.

GCSEs are qualifications that enable learners to progress to further qualifications either Vocational or General.

This qualification provides the ideal foundation for learners to progress to OCR AS or A Level Geography.

Find out more at [www.ocr.org.uk](http://www.ocr.org.uk)